Open Budget Privacy Policy

Effective Nov 2, 2026 · Jacob Shade

Who we are and what this covers

Open Budget is a self-hosted personal finance app operated by Jacob Shade ("we", "us"). It shows your bank accounts, balances and transactions in one place, using data you choose to share through Plaid.

This policy covers all information Open Budget collects, stores and uses. Access is limited to people the operator has personally approved; there is no public sign-up.

Information we collect

We collect only what is needed to sign you in and show your finances.

Category	What it includes	Where it comes from
Account profile	Google account ID, email address, name, profile picture link	Google, when you sign in
Sign-in security	Authenticator app secret, hashed recovery codes, hashed session tokens, sign-in timestamps	Created by Open Budget when you set up two-factor sign-in
Bank connections	Institution name, Plaid item ID and access token	Plaid, when you connect a bank
Accounts	Account name, type, last 4 digits of the account number, current and available balance, credit limit, currency	Plaid
Transactions	Date, amount, description, merchant name, category, pending status, merchant logo link	Plaid
Operational logs	Request errors, sync results, and the email address of any rejected sign-in attempt	Generated by the app

We do **not** collect or store your bank username or password; you enter those directly with Plaid or your bank. We do not receive full account numbers, routing numbers, or identity documents.

How we use your information

Your information is used only to run Open Budget for you:

- Sign you in and confirm it's really you (Google sign-in plus an authenticator code)
- Retrieve and refresh your accounts, balances and transactions from Plaid
- Show your net worth, accounts, transactions and budgeting features

- Keep the service secure, investigate problems, and meet legal obligations

We never sell your information, use it for advertising, share it with data brokers, or use it to train AI models.

Plaid and Google

Open Budget uses Plaid Inc. to connect to your financial institutions. When you click **Connect a bank**, Plaid's window opens, and you sign in to your bank and choose which accounts to share. By doing so, you consent to Plaid collecting your data from your bank as described in the Plaid End User Privacy Policy. We receive only the account and transaction data listed above.

Open Budget uses Google to sign you in. Google shares your account ID, email address, name and profile picture with us, as described in the Google Privacy Policy. We do not access your Gmail, Drive, contacts or any other Google data.

Sharing and disclosure

We share information only in these cases:

- **Plaid**, to retrieve and refresh your financial data, and to revoke access when you disconnect a bank
- **Google**, to verify your identity at sign-in
- **Hosting provider**, if Open Budget is moved off the operator's own hardware; it would store only the encrypted database and could not read it
- **Legal requirements**, when required by law, subpoena or court order, or to protect against fraud or a security threat

We do not share information with anyone else.

How we store and protect your information

- **Encrypted at rest:** the entire database, including bank connection tokens, accounts, balances, transactions and sign-in data, is encrypted with AES-256 using SQLCipher. The encryption key is kept separately from the database.
- **Encrypted in transit:** all connections to Plaid and Google use TLS 1.2 or higher. Open Budget is currently reachable only from the computer it runs on; before it is made reachable over any network, it will be served only over HTTPS with TLS 1.2 or higher.
- **Access control:** signing in requires an approved Google account plus a code from an authenticator app. Sessions expire after 7 days, and repeated wrong codes end the sign-in attempt.
- **Data minimization:** bank credentials never reach Open Budget, and access tokens are never sent to your browser.

No system is perfectly secure. If a breach affects your information, we will notify you without undue delay.

Retention and deletion

We keep financial data only while the bank connection that produced it is active.

Data	How long we keep it
Accounts and transactions	Until you remove the bank connection. Removing it revokes Plaid's access and deletes that bank's accounts and transactions immediately.
Bank connection token	Until you remove the connection; it is revoked at Plaid and deleted.
Account profile and sign-in security data	Until you ask us to delete your account.
Sessions	7 days, or until you sign out. Unfinished sign-ins expire after 10 minutes.
Operational logs	Kept only as long as the running server retains them; they contain no transactions or balances.

Any backup copy of the database is encrypted the same way as the live database.

Your rights and choices

- **Disconnect a bank:** click **Remove** next to the bank in Open Budget. You can also revoke access at my.plaid.com.
- **Access or export:** ask us for a copy of the information we hold about you.
- **Correction:** account and transaction data comes from your bank, so corrections should be made with your bank; the next sync picks them up.
- **Deletion:** ask us to delete your account. We will revoke all bank connections and delete everything we hold about you within 30 days.
- **Withdraw consent:** you can stop using Open Budget at any time. Removing all connections stops all data collection from your banks.

We respond to requests within 30 days. Depending on where you live, you may have additional rights under local law, such as California's CCPA.

Children

Open Budget is not intended for anyone under 18, and we do not knowingly collect information from children.

Changes to this policy

We will update the effective date above when this policy changes. For material changes, we will notify approved users by email before the change takes effect.

Contact

Questions, requests or concerns about your privacy: Jacob Shade, shadejacob@gmail.com.